

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner, SME & Online Banking.*

Positioning, Thirteen years owning regulated digital products end-to-end, from discovery through live operations, with a track record of shipping mobile and web solutions at pace.

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§ WHY THIS COMPANY

SME digital banking is one of the hardest product problems in financial services: the journeys are more complex than retail, the customer tolerance for friction is lower, and the regulatory surface is wider. What makes this role specifically interesting is the global-by-default governance mandate, maintaining consistency across markets while letting local squads own their backlogs is exactly the kind of multi-level product discipline that separates a strategic PO from a backlog manager. The combination of mobile and online ownership within a single scope, alongside a direct people-leadership remit, reflects how mature digital banking organisations are structured. *That is precisely the scope where my cross-functional delivery experience compounds most.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not owned a live SME or Business Banking product inside a licensed bank. My financial services product experience is in payments (Kvitt, acquired by Sparkasse into the girocard ecosystem) and B2B insurance SaaS (EMIL Group), rather than in-app business current accounts or SME lending journeys. The transferable mechanic is strong: regulated, multi-stakeholder product ownership with real operational accountability and customer satisfaction metrics is the same discipline, the domain vocabulary is the gap, not the craft.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming across squad tasks
- **Cursor**, context-aware refactors and review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy interface validation
- **GPT**, stakeholder brief drafting and document synthesis
- **Gamma.app**, strategy and roadmap decks
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, zero to one, built and operated solo.

- Matches construction firms with workers, removing the headhunter from the hiring loop with an anonymity-until-payment model.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, keeping adoption friction near zero for a non-app-native customer segment.
- LLM agents across the funnel so a single operator runs day-to-day matching, outreach and conversion tracking.
- Funnel and churn analysis in SQL, demonstrating the same self-service adoption and digital engagement measurement the SME banking role requires.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THIS COMPANY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow squad ceremonies, read the existing backlog and roadmap artefacts, and map where the SME and online banking journeys break, focusing on incidents, defect age, and CSAT signal, before forming any opinion about priorities.

WEEK 2

Align and sharpen.

Run structured conversations with Engineering, UX, and Business Banking leadership to surface competing priorities, then produce a first-pass priority order with explicit trade-off rationale ready for challenge.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Own the next sprint planning session, move the highest-value items through refinement to ready state, and establish a weekly operational performance review so early-life incidents surface fast and get resolved faster.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

The Product Owner for SME & Online Banking role sits at the intersection of the two things I find most demanding in product work: genuine end-to-end accountability across a live digital service, and the organisational complexity of aligning global platform standards with squad-level delivery. That combination is not common in product job descriptions, and it is the environment where I do my best work.

My most directly transferable experience is at EMIL Group, where I inherited an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing senior engineers and client trust simultaneously. I restructured it into three lean squads with clear ownership, brought attrition from near-total to a single departure, and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production inside the same period. The Claims Center is a complex, multi-party workflow product, analogous in structure to SME banking journeys, and getting it live required the same balance of discovery rigour,

backlog discipline, and stakeholder management that this role demands. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked inside a fully SAFe environment with agile release trains and PI planning, moving research results into production across a matrix organisation, the closest structural equivalent to managing dependencies across global platform and local squad layers.

On the customer experience side, the CLINET Platforms role taught me that a backlog cut ruthlessly to the top 10% of features, measured against agreed success criteria, produces better user acceptance than a long list of shipped items. User acceptance at CLINET rose more than fivefold after that cut. I apply the same logic to metrics like CSAT, NPS, and self-service adoption: they are not reporting artefacts, they are the feedback loop that tells you whether the roadmap decision was correct.

I am honest about the gap: I have not owned a live SME banking product inside a licensed bank. My payments experience, building Kvitt from zero through acquisition by Sparkasse into the girocard ecosystem, and my insurance SaaS work at EMIL Group give me regulated, multi-stakeholder product ownership at real scale, but the specific SME banking journey vocabulary is something I would close in the first weeks rather than arrive already knowing. What I bring on day one is the product craft, the delivery discipline, and the people leadership experience to build the team around me while I do.

I would be glad to walk through any of the above in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of end-to-end product ownership in regulated industries, payments, insurance, public-sector analytics, healthcare, and defence AI. I shape roadmaps, run continuous discovery, lead cross-functional agile squads through Scrum and SAFe, and hold accountability for live service performance beyond the release gate. My track record spans both early-stage product creation and the operational discipline that keeps a live digital channel running: incident ownership, defect triage, and continuous optimisation based on customer and business metrics.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: epics, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, agile release train, PI planning, WIP limits.

Platform and Delivery Practices: GitOps, ArgoCD, CI/CD, containerised environments, regression and end-to-end test automation, release gating, hotfix paths, defect-to-fix and cycle time as product metrics.

Customer Experience and Analytics: CSAT, NPS, MAU, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, digital engagement, self-service adoption measurement, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management, direct report development.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI & DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Owned the internal AI and data Platform for the FCAS European programme; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum. GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes; developer-code-first prioritisation lifted pipeline runs by 200%. Stack: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitLab, Python, Dagster.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics Platform for policymakers; Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving ~75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal to containers and launched a full UI relaunch alongside a large ETL migration. Stack: Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP
2023-2023

iOS/Android patient app piloted in hospitals. Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into KIS: digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM
2022-2022

B2B SaaS Platform for insurers and underwriters. Restructured 18-person org into three lean squads; attrition near-zero. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL &
PAYMENTS 2021-2022

POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA
PLATFORM 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B
PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end, Wismar and Magdeburg.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025-PRESENT

Two-sided B2B marketplace, zero to one solo: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer security product that installs in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY & AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · PEOPLE STRATEGIST

